Ardú

Project summary for supporters · September 2026 · prepared by the founder, Ahmed Abuhassan

What Ardú is

Ardú is Irish for a lifting, a raising up. It is a youth initiative built in Gaza, for Gaza: a 500 square metre hall in central Gaza City, standing on intact columns with war damage to the roof and walls, restored into a place where young people get what stands between them and an opportunity. That is almost never ability. It is a seat, stable power, a stable connection, and somebody who has walked the road before them.

The hall is planned to open with 200 seats at a time, subject to the engineer's structural sign-off, in two sessions a day, which means around 400 young people a day, aged 18 and over, with separate sessions for men and women on identical hours and services. On top of the space, the plan is for recurring courses delivered with partner organisations as each partnership is agreed, with certificates issued by the partner, English, freelancing and remote work, career readiness and digital skills, repeating in cycles so anyone who misses a round catches the next, and live sessions with people from the founder's own network, people who run organisations, teach at universities and lead teams. Freelancers and remote workers rent paid desks, and paid courses are open to people outside the supported categories, so the place earns part of its own keep and stays open when donations slow. No partner is named in this document until its agreement is signed. Ardú is not relief. The measure of its work is income and professional progress for young people, from where they are.

The impact at a glance

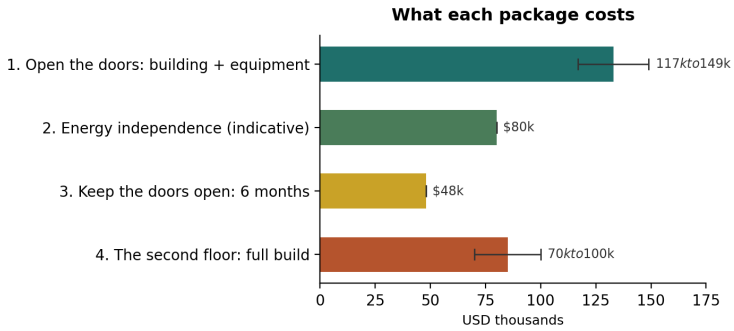
What	Number
Planned seats each day at opening	**400, in two sessions of 200**
Planned capacity in seat-days a year	**about 115,000 seat-days at opening, 288,000 at full build**
Positions in Gaza at opening, on written contracts, the founder's among them	**8**
Course tracks planned, in repeating cycles, with partners	**4**
Electricity cost avoided by the solar system, against a paid supply at today's rate	**about $24,000 a year**
Surplus electricity	**local water wells and street lighting at night; above 5 kW, sold and saved into the project's reserve**
Capacity at full build, if the engineer confirms a second floor	**500 seats per session, up to 1,000 a day**
Who gets in	**adults 18 and over, on criteria published before the first intake**

What your support delivers, package by package

The project is funded in packages. Each one is a thing you can see, photograph, and count, and each one comes with its own receipts. Every figure is an estimate at Gaza prices as of September 2026, to be confirmed by written quotes before any money is spent, and the notes on the energy package apply to all of them.

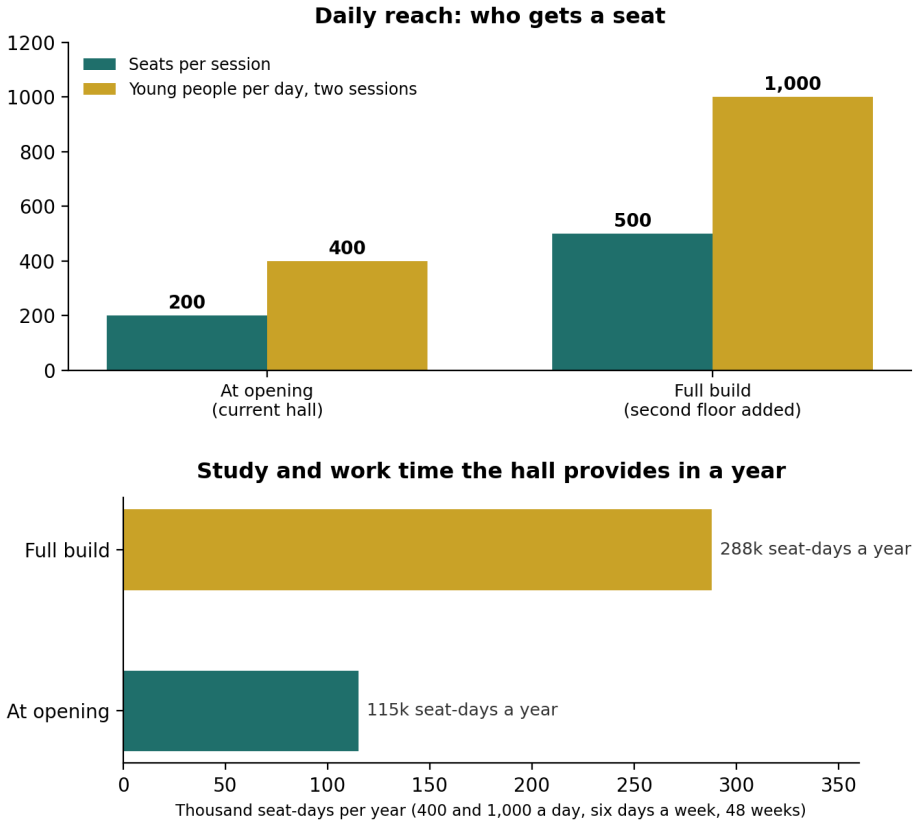
Package	Amount	What changes on the ground, and what you can verify

1. Open the doors: the building and its equipment	**$117k to $149k**	The hall restored without cement, with sheeting and salvaged steel. Toilets and water. Lighting and wiring. A 500 Mbps fibre line shared by up to 200 seats at a time. Furniture for 200 seats. 20 shared laptops. A secured equipment room. Ventilation. A 10 percent contingency is inside the figure. For a young person, this is the move from a tent or a room that keeps out neither the summer heat nor the winter cold and offers none of the basics of a decent life, to a place with stable power and a stable connection all day. Verifiable by the engineer's report, the invoices for every item, the fibre contract, and photographs of each stage.
2. Energy independence: the solar and storage system	**about $80k, indicative**	A 50 kW solar system with storage, sized for the full 500-seat build, so every seat has reliable power from the day the system is commissioned, and the hall's daily running no longer depends on a generator or a paid supply. About $24,000 a year in electricity cost avoided against a paid supply at today's rate, before maintenance and eventual battery replacement. Verifiable by the quotes, installation photographs, and the system's own monitoring data, which can be shared with the funder. Details and caveats on page 4.
3. Keep the doors open: six months of running	**$48k**	Eight positions on written contracts in Gaza: a site manager, a programme coordinator, a technical officer, two reception staff, maintenance, accounts, and the founder as chief executive, all starting at a quarter of their full pay and stepping up together as funding grows. Internet, consumables, communications. The first cycles of partner-run courses and live sessions. Verifiable by the contracts, the monthly payroll sheet, attendance numbers and the course calendar.
4. The second floor: full build	**$70k to $100k**	If the engineer's assessment confirms it, a steel second floor and cement finishing when materials allow, taking capacity to 500 seats per session and up to 1,000 young people a day. An under-18 programme with its own staffing and rules. The same services delivered at a far wider scale online. Verifiable by the structural report and photographs.



Packages 1, 2 and 3 together open Ardú and keep it open for its first six months: **$245k to $277k**. With a full year of running at the second salary level the total is $353k to $385k, and two years at full pay is $749k to $781k. The full four-year picture, including the second floor, is around $1.4 million before the income from paid desks and courses.

The impact in detail



Year one

The doors open at 200 seats a session and 400 young people a day. The first four course tracks begin cycling with partner organisations, and the first live sessions run with people from the founder's network. Eight positions are filled, on written contracts, from the first month, the founder's among them. Paid desks for freelancers start from month three and begin covering part of the running cost. Every month a statement of spending against the plan goes to supporters.

Year two

The team moves up the salary ladder as funding grows. Partner-run courses reach their full rhythm, with certificates issued by the partner behind each cycle. Paid desks and paid courses cover a growing share of the running cost. The second floor is built if funded and structurally confirmed.

Years three and four

With the second floor, if built, 500 seats a session and up to 1,000 young people a day. The under-18 programme opens with its own staff and rules. The same services are delivered online, past the walls of one building, to people no hall in Gaza could seat. By month 40 the solar system has paid for itself against what a paid supply would have cost, before maintenance and battery replacement.

The energy package

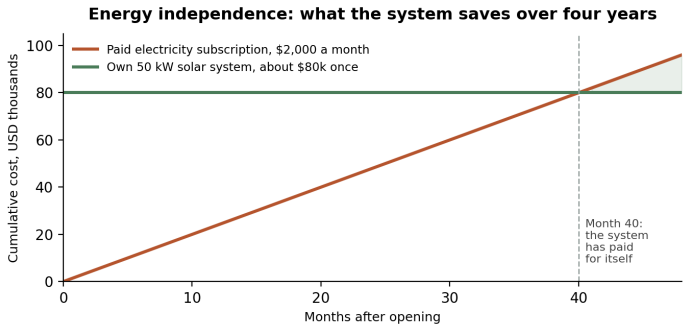
Energy is the strand that decides whether everything else works, and Ardú opens with the full system rather than a small one that grows later, so the promise of power holds from the day the system is commissioned.

The system

A 50 kW solar system with battery storage. The size is set by the full build, 500 seats at roughly 100 watts each, which leaves a wide margin for the 200-seat opening, the lighting, the network, and air conditioning in a sealed hall. Mounting position and the split between panels and storage are decided at the site survey.

Three things to read before the number

> **The price is a reference price.** The figure of about $80,000 is a standard, indicative price for a system of this size. Real prices in Gaza move daily with what crosses in and what is stuck at the border. A field visit is needed before a final quote. The final figure is not expected to differ drastically from what is shown here.
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> **The figure covers the system only.** Panels, batteries and inverters. Cabling, installation, and the fees of the team that installs it are not yet in the budget, because those have no fixed price in Gaza today either. They will be priced from written quotes at the site survey and added openly.
>
> **The comparison that matters.** Without its own system, the hall would run on a paid electricity subscription at around $2,000 a month. Energy independence removes that cost for the working life of the system, before maintenance and eventual battery replacement, which is the difference between a place that can only afford a few hours of power and a place that runs all day.



What the surplus does

A 50 kW system sized for the full build will run ahead of the hall's own load for years, and that surplus is not wasted. A modest surplus goes into the neighbourhood: it runs local water wells, lights the street at night, and powers whatever else around the hall carries a community benefit. When the surplus grows beyond 5 kW, the electricity is sold to nearby homes and businesses under written agreements, and every dollar it earns is held in a reserve that funds the project's running costs. The system pays the hall's bills first, then its neighbours, then its own future.

The energy package can be funded as a standalone package by a supporter or a group of supporters, with its own line in the accounts and its own set of receipts and photographs, from the

first invoice to the last panel on the roof. The site survey, the quotes and the installation are handled with engineers and technicians the founder worked beside before he turned to software; more on that on the last page.

How the money moves, and how you can see it

Ardú launches as an unregistered initiative, as most active projects in Gaza currently operate, and says so plainly. Formal registration is planned once the building stands. Because of that, the money has to be more visible than a registered charity's, not less. This is the system every contribution runs through:

1. **One door in.** Contributions come in through a single donation link and are held in the United Kingdom by an academic trustee under a signed trustee agreement, on the model of the agreement that carried the founder's own education fund with nearly 800 supporters in more than a dozen countries.
2. **Transfer against the plan.** The trustee transfers funds to a bank account in the founder's name used only for Ardú, for spending in Gaza, package by package, so money for the energy package buys energy and nothing else.
3. **Every transaction documented.** Every purchase carries its invoice or receipt, every salary its contract, and every piece of equipment a photograph of it installed. Transactions are numbered in one ledger, in the order they happen, from the first restoration invoice onward.
4. **Recording is separate from spending.** The person who keeps the ledger is not the person who spends. A part-time accounts role records daily with receipts and reconciles the ledger against the bank every month.
5. **You see what we see.** Supporters receive a monthly itemised statement of spending against the plan, with the receipts and photographs behind it, package by package. Any funder or partner who wants the full ledger can have it, with the personal details of staff and students protected.

The founder's own name, face and record are behind every line of this. His public record was built on one habit, stating a verifiable fact and attaching the document, and Ardú is run the same way.

The numbers in detail

Phase-one capital, building and equipment (USD thousands)

Item	Estimate
Initial restoration: sheeting, salvaged steel, labour	**15**
Secured equipment room	**3 to 5**
Sanitation, water and drainage	**15 to 20**
Fibre installation, 500 Mbps	**5 to 8**
Internal network and UPS	**3 to 5**
Lighting and wiring	**10 to 12**
Furniture, 200 seats	**30 to 40**
20 shared laptops with peripherals	**20 to 25**
Ventilation and air conditioning	**5**
Subtotal	**106 to 135**
Contingency, 10 percent	**11 to 14**
Package 1 total	**117 to 149**

Energy package (USD thousands)

Item	Estimate
50 kW solar system with storage: panels, batteries, inverters, indicative reference price	**about 80**
Cabling, installation, installer team fees	**to be priced at site survey**

Monthly running costs and the salary ladder (USD)

Salaries run on a four-level ladder tied to funding. Everyone starts at a quarter of the full rate, and the whole team steps up together as funding grows, so payroll never burdens the initiative while it is small. Fixed running costs are 3,000 a month: internet 500, consumables and water 400, communications and tools 100, and a 2,000 electricity allowance that the solar system is expected to remove, or shrink to maintenance and backup.

Salary level	Payroll	Fixed	Monthly total
Level 1, launch: quarter salaries	**5,000**	**3,000**	**8,000**
Level 2: half salaries	**10,000**	**3,000**	**13,000**
Level 3: three-quarter salaries	**15,000**	**3,000**	**18,000**
Level 4: full salaries	**20,000**	**3,000**	**23,000**

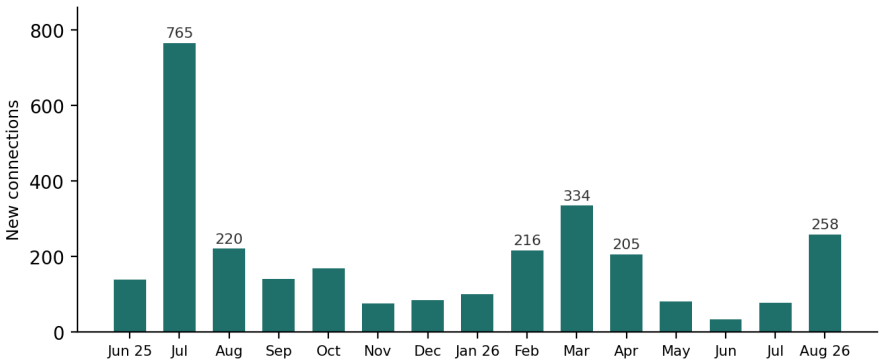
Full rates are set above the local market on purpose, to attract and hold the strongest available staff under wartime inflation. The hall is family property. The initiative uses it under a written use agreement at a symbolic rent, pays for its restoration, and the improvements stay with Ardú for the term of the agreement. The rent is added to the accounts once set.

Who is behind it

Ahmed Abuhassan, 21, from Gaza City. A self-taught front-end developer who taught himself the profession through the genocide, holder of a place and a full four-year scholarship at University College Dublin, and the founder of Ardú. Every line below is documented, and the documents are available to any funder who asks.

When	What
October 2023	The family home destroyed in an airstrike. Eighteen months displaced in the south, mostly in tents.
2024 to 2025	Taught himself front-end development from a tent, on a borrowed laptop, walking daily to find a power socket and a signal. Freelance since August 2024: 14 production sites for local retailers, NGOs and startups.
2025	Four Meta front-end certificates. Five Frontend Masters courses. HarvardX Professional Certificate in Leadership and Communication, including Rhetoric and Exercising Leadership. EF SET C1 Advanced in English, entirely self-taught.
December 2025	Offer from University College Dublin. A full four-year scholarship structured with the university, with living costs funded by nearly 800 individual supporters in more than a dozen countries.
July to August 2026	After a visa refusal in July 2026, national Irish media coverage within a week, and the case raised at ministerial level and by the universities' sector. Sat the Duolingo English Test from inside Gaza; the post about it reached nearly 95,000 impressions. Built his own power and internet workspace, the six-thousand-dollar setup that powers one person.
Today	A public professional record of more than 680,000 impressions and more than 300,000 people reached in the last twelve months, more than 5,000 followers, more than 3,000 connections, over a quarter of them in leadership roles by their public titles, and more than 550 of them in Ireland.

How the founder built the network: new professional connections per month



How he works

Running a place like Ardú is mostly not a technical job. It is people, money, trust and follow-through, and the record above shows those in practice rather than in adjectives.

Communication that moves institutions. The HarvardX certificate in leadership and communication is the paper; the practice is a refused-visa case taken to national media within a week and raised at ministerial level and across the universities' sector. The method is always the same: state a verifiable fact, attach the document, and ask for people's voice rather than their help.

Relationships built by hand, across distance. The network was not inherited and did not go viral. It was built one message at a time, 1,097 invitations sent and 5,262 messages written personally, from a tent and then from one repaired room, until it held more than 550 Irish connections, with over a quarter of the whole network in leadership roles. Followers now outnumber connections by around two thousand, which means people chose to read him without any relationship in return.

Trusted with other people's money. Nearly 800 donors, payouts coordinated across several currencies, and funds held under a signed trustee agreement. Ardú inherits that discipline as it stands, and adds a ledger, separated duties and monthly statements on top.

Follow-through in the worst conditions. A profession and a language taught to himself under bombardment, an international English test sat from inside Gaza, client work delivered on time from a room he repaired with his own hands, and a workspace built from panels and a battery so the work never stopped.

Systems other people can run. The Ardú operating model was designed before a single dollar arrived: eight roles with written responsibilities, spending separated from recording and approval, a salary ladder tied to funding so the team never outgrows the money, and one ledger that supporters can read.

Feet on the ground for the energy work. Before software he worked in electrical installations and wiring, and the engineers and technicians he worked beside are still a phone call away. That grounding, basic but real, is what lets the site survey, the quotes and the installation be handled by people he knows rather than by strangers.

Contact: Ahmed Abuhassan, founder. LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/ahmadabohassan. All figures are estimates at current Gaza prices; the larger items depend on written quotes at execution time.